

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE & RISK ANALYSIS

Israel's Dog Services Market

Who Operates, What Failed & Why Now

Covering: Dogiz · DogMen · Facebook Groups · Market Risks · Reasons to Enter

0 National Platforms No active marketplace in Israel	636,542 Registered Active Dogs 2025 — Ministry of Agriculture	2025 Dogiz Exits Market AI assets sold to US company	\$5.14B Global Market 2030E Pet sitting CAGR 11.73%
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Report Overview

This report analyses the competitive landscape for dog care services in Israel, evaluating each active and historical player, assessing the structural gap in the market, and identifying the key risks facing any new entrant in 2026.

Key finding: Israel currently has no national dog services marketplace. The only Israeli-built platform (Dogiz) left the marketplace in 2023. The premium agency operator (DogMen) is Tel Aviv-only and structurally unable to scale. The informal market (Facebook groups) dominates but offers no trust, payment, or accountability layer.

Seven structural reasons make 2026 the optimal window for market entry.

Key Sources:

- [Calcalist Tech](#)
- [Israel21c](#)
- [DogMen](#)
- [Ministry of Agriculture](#)
- [ResearchAndMarkets](#)

A. The Gap: 636,542 Dogs, Zero National Platform

WHO SERVES
THEM TODAY?

Facebook groups,
word of mouth,
individual freelancers

IS THERE A
MARKETPLACE?

No. Zero national
platform exists.
Dogiz exited 2023.

IS THERE
PROOF OF DEMAND?

Yes. DogMen thrives
in Tel Aviv.
Millennials pay premium.

B. How Dog Owners Find Services Today

The Facebook / WhatsApp Economy

- Owner posts a request in a city-specific Facebook group or neighborhood WhatsApp chat.
- Freelance walkers/sitters respond in the comments with a phone number.
- Transaction agreed over WhatsApp — cash or bank transfer.
- No reviews, no insurance, no GPS tracking, no background checks, no accountability.
- No platform captures the transaction, the relationship, or the recurring revenue.

C. Why This Gap Exists — Structural Reasons

Small market misperception

Israel's ~640K dogs seemed niche in 2014–2018. In 2026 it is clearly a multi-billion-dollar market.

Underfunded attempts

Dogiz raised only \$100K — insufficient to build supply, demand, and trust simultaneously at national scale.

COVID disruption

The pandemic hit walking-based models in 2020 precisely when they were gaining traction.

War & operational risk

October 7 forced Israeli founders into reserve duty, collapsing early-stage operations with no resilience layer.

Agency model dominates

DogMen's success validated demand but anchored the market in a non-scalable model, discouraging platform thinking.

Source: [Ministry of Agriculture — National Dog Registry 2025](#)

DOGIZ · Tel Aviv · Founded 2014 · Marketplace exited 2023 · AI assets sold 2025

HISTORICAL — EXITED

\$100K

Total Funding Raised
Samurai Incubate Japan

92%

Users Order 3x/Week
Peak retention metric

~\$90

Avg Weekly Spend/User
At platform peak

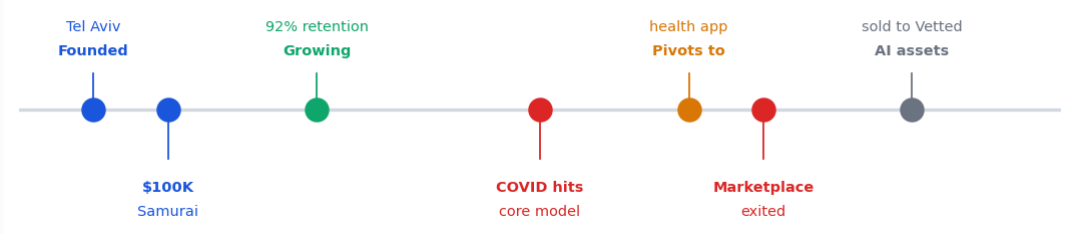
2025

AI Assets Acquired
By Vetted Pet Health, US

What Dogiz Was

- Israeli-built mobile platform connecting dog owners with professional dog walking companies in their neighbourhood.
- GPS real-time tracking, online payment, walker management tools (invoicing, scheduling, billing).
- Founded at IDC Herzliya by Danny Djanogly (London) & Alon Zlatkin (Kazakhstan) — both IDF veterans, both dog owners.
- Incubated at TheHive accelerator for olim. Won \$100K from Samurai Incubate (Japan) in March 2015.
- Later pivoted to AI dog health features: Dr. Poop, Dr. Skin, Dr. Teeth, Dr. Eye, Dr. Weight.

Dogiz — Company Timeline (2014–2025)



Why It Failed — Four Confirmed Reasons

COVID-19 (2020)

■ [Israel21c](#)

Core business = dog walking while owners are at work. Lockdowns eliminated demand overnight. Fatal to the model.

Underfunded (\$100K total)

■ [Tracxn](#)

Insufficient capital to build supply (walkers), demand (owners), and trust simultaneously at scale.

October 7 / Miluim (2023–2024)

■ [Calcalist Tech](#)

Founders called up for nearly a year of reserve duty. No operational resilience. Company stalled.

Pivot away from core product (2022–2023)

■ [Calcalist Tech](#)

Shifted from walking marketplace to health app in 2022 — marketplace effectively exited by 2023.

Verdict:

Dogiz validated demand — Israeli owners will pay for a professional digital platform.
Left the marketplace in 2023. AI assets sold 2025. The space has been open for two years.

DOGMEN · Rothschild Blvd 45, Tel Aviv · Founded ~2016 · Active**✓ LOW THREAT — PROOF OF CONCEPT****✓ Strengths**

- 9+ years in business — proven survival
- Premium agency model, trained staff
- Max 2 dogs per walker — quality focus
- Insurance on every service
- Own GPS app with real-time tracking
- 98% satisfaction (82 Facebook reviews)
- Niche services: weddings, corporates, running
- Founder: IDF Oketz (canine unit) veteran

✗ Limitations

- Tel Aviv only — no national coverage
- Agency model = capped by headcount
- Cannot scale without hiring & training
- No marketplace — no network effects
- No supply-side growth mechanism
- 82 reviews in 9 years = niche, not mass
- Premium pricing limits addressable market
- Not a platform — does not aggregate supply

Verdict — Not a threat, but a proof of concept:

DogMen proves Israeli dog owners pay premium for trusted, professional service. It cannot scale.

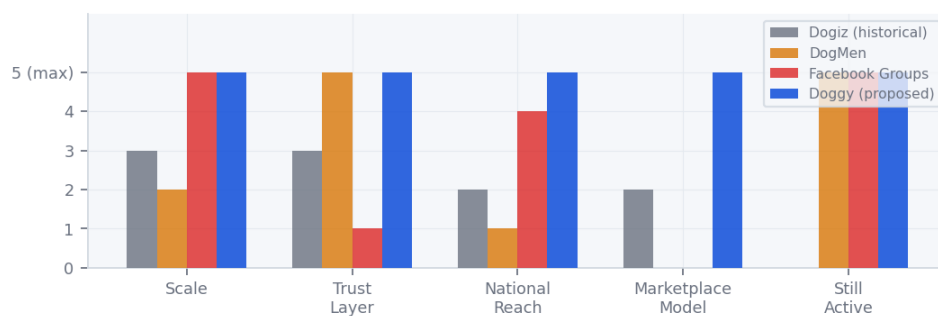
Doggy takes the validated model national via a marketplace.

FACEBOOK & WHATSAPP GROUPS · Informal Market · Dominant but Unmonetised**FRAGMENTED****What it is today**

- 5M+ Israelis active in Facebook groups
- Hundreds of city & neighbourhood pet groups
- Owners post requests, freelancers respond
- Transactions via phone / cash / bank transfer
- No centralised matching or payment

Why it's vulnerable to disruption

- Zero trust layer — anyone can respond
- No insurance or liability coverage
- No reviews or reputation system
- No recurring booking or payment rails
- Post-Oct. 7: owners demand accountability

Competitive Positioning Matrix — Score out of 5

E. Why 2026 Is the Optimal Window for Market Entry

1	Dogiz Just Exited — The Space Is Empty The only Israeli-built dog walking platform sold its AI assets to a US company in July 2025. No incumbent to displace. ■ Calcalist Tech
2	Dog Population at All-Time High 636,542 registered active dogs in 2025 — up 4.3% YoY. Post-COVID and post-Oct. 7 pet adoption surged. ■ Ministry of Agriculture
3	No National Platform Exists DogMen is Tel Aviv-only. Facebook groups have no monetisation, trust layer, or insurance. Market is fragmented. ■ DogMen
4	Israeli Tech Infrastructure Is Ready Payment rails (Bit, PayBox), GPS, 90%+ smartphone penetration. Building a marketplace in 2026 is fast and cheap. ■ Ministry of Agriculture
5	Post-War Behavioral Shift October 7 changed how Israelis think about trust. Owners want vetted, insured, accountable service providers. ■ Euromonitor
6	Global Market Validation — Rover Sold to Blackstone Rover acquired by PE giant Blackstone in 2024. A major buyout firm does not acquire a dog app unless category is proven. ■ Wikipedia
7	Millennials + Dual-Income Households Growing Urban millennials treating dogs as family, working long hours — this demographic is larger and richer in 2026. ■ Times of Israel

F. Key Risks of Market Entry

Trust & Supply Quality

Building a verified, insured, background-checked supply side of walkers/sitters is operationally complex.

Funding & Runway

Two-sided marketplace needs simultaneous supply & demand investment. Undercapitalisation was Dogiz's fatal flaw.

Global Players Entering

Rover and Holidog don't currently operate in Israel. If market validates, international entry is a risk.

Marketplace Timing Risk

First-mover advantage is real but so is the cold-start problem — building supply and demand simultaneously is the hardest challenge in marketplace creation.

G. Conclusions

Israel's Dog Services Market — State of Play, May 2026

1 The market gap is structural, not incidental.

No national platform has ever achieved scale. This is not a saturated market — it is an untouched one.

2 Demand has been independently validated.

Dogiz proved retention. DogMen proved willingness to pay premium. Both point to strong product-market fit.

3 The timing is favourable.

Dogiz exit (2025), all-time high dog population, post-war trust shift, and global category validation align uniquely in 2026.

4 The risks are manageable.

Regulatory, supply-quality, and geographic risks are real but addressable with adequate planning and capital.

5 The informal market is the real competitor.

Facebook groups dominate today — but they are highly vulnerable to a platform offering trust, payments, and reliability.

All Sources Referenced in This Report:

- [Ministry of Agriculture — National Dog Registry 20...](#)
- [Israel21c — Dogiz links urban dog parents with loc...](#)
- [Times of Israel — Why Tel Aviv is so crazy about d...](#)
- [DogMen — About page, founder story](#)
- [Ynet — Israel pet market ILS 2B+ \(2023\)](#)
- [ResearchAndMarkets — Global Pet Sitting Market \\$5...](#)
- [Tracxn — Dogiz company profile](#)

- [Calcalist Tech — Vetted Pet Health acquires Dogiz ...](#)
- [Jerusalem Post — Two olim launch Dogiz walking ser...](#)
- [DogMen — Official website](#)
- [Secret Tel Aviv — Dog Walkers directory](#)
- [Wikipedia — Rover Group acquired by Blackstone \(20...](#)
- [Euromonitor — Pet abandonment & re-adoption during...](#)